



# Saudi Arabia

Asia

Oryx horns can be up to 30 in (76 cm) long

0 150 km  
0 150 miles  
(approximate scale)



## Arabian oryx

This desert antelope had become extinct in the wild by 1972 but was reintroduced during the 1980s. Today, more than a thousand white oryx roam the sandy desert of the Empty Quarter.



## Seasonal waterways

Saudi Arabia has no permanent rivers due to low annual rainfall. However, dry riverbeds, called wadis, fill up during brief rainy periods.

## Sacred city

The Prophet Muhammad, founder of Islam, was born in the city of Mecca. Millions of Muslims make the Hajj, or pilgrimage, to this sacred city.

Muslims pray in the direction of the Kaaba, Islam's most sacred shrine, at the center of Mecca's Great Mosque.

## Cultural festival

Saudi Arabia enjoys an annual two-week cultural celebration at Al-Janadriyah, near Riyadh. Thousands gather here to enjoy dances and feasts.



This oil refinery stands in the city of Ad Dammām, one of the most oil-rich locations in the world.



## Exporting oil

One-fifth of the world's known oil reserves is found in the oil fields of Saudi Arabia. The country is a leading global oil exporter.



8,300,000 sq miles (2,149,690 sq km)

34.2 million

Riyadh

Arabic

Located in the **Arabian Peninsula**, Saudi Arabia is the center of the Islamic faith and home to the **holy sites** of **Mecca** and **Medina**. Its **large reserves** of **oil** and **gas** make this country one of the **world's wealthiest**.

